

Hanoi Towers Illegal State Algorithms Performance Analysis

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```
# Read data from CSV
data <- read.csv("results.csv")

# Convert to factors with readable labels
data$stack_algorithm <- factor(data$stack_algorithm,
                               levels = c("dig_out", "a_star"),
                               labels = c("Dig-Out", "A*"))
data$ground_algorithm <- factor(data$ground_algorithm,
                                levels = c("greedy", "patient"),
                                labels = c("Greedy", "Patient"))
data$corruption_rate <- factor(data$corruption_rate,
                               levels = c(0.05, 0.1),
                               labels = c("5%", "10%"))

# Rename for clarity in analysis
data$stack <- data$stack_algorithm
data$ground <- data$ground_algorithm
data$corruption <- data$corruption_rate
data$value <- data$total_moves

str(data)

## 'data.frame': 800 obs. of 15 variables:
## $ trial_id : chr "C1_T1" "C1_T2" "C1_T3" "C1_T4" ...
## $ condition_id : int 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ stack_algorithm : Factor w/ 2 levels "Dig-Out","A*": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ ground_algorithm : Factor w/ 2 levels "Greedy","Patient": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ corruption_rate : Factor w/ 2 levels "5%","10%": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ seed : int 100 200 300 400 500 600 700 800 900 1000 ...
## $ total_moves : int 9 4 19 5 5 15 25 5 13 28 ...
## $ num_regenerations : int 2 1 1 1 1 4 2 1 1 1 ...
## $ num_corruptions_occurred: int 1 0 0 0 0 3 2 0 0 0 ...
## $ final_state_valid : chr "True" "True" "True" "True" ...
## $ timeout : chr "False" "False" "False" "False" ...
## $ stack : Factor w/ 2 levels "Dig-Out","A*": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ ground : Factor w/ 2 levels "Greedy","Patient": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ corruption : Factor w/ 2 levels "5%","10%": 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 1 ...
## $ value : int 9 4 19 5 5 15 25 5 13 28 ...

head(data)

## trial_id condition_id stack_algorithm ground_algorithm corruption_rate seed
```

```

## 1    C1_T1          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 100
## 2    C1_T2          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 200
## 3    C1_T3          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 300
## 4    C1_T4          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 400
## 5    C1_T5          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 500
## 6    C1_T6          1      Dig-Out      Greedy          5% 600
##      total_moves num_regenerations num_corruptions_occurred final_state_valid
## 1          9          2              1              True
## 2          4          1              0              True
## 3         19          1              0              True
## 4          5          1              0              True
## 5          5          1              0              True
## 6         15          4              3              True
##      timeout   stack ground corruption value
## 1   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%    9
## 2   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%    4
## 3   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%   19
## 4   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%    5
## 5   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%    5
## 6   False Dig-Out Greedy          5%   15

```

```

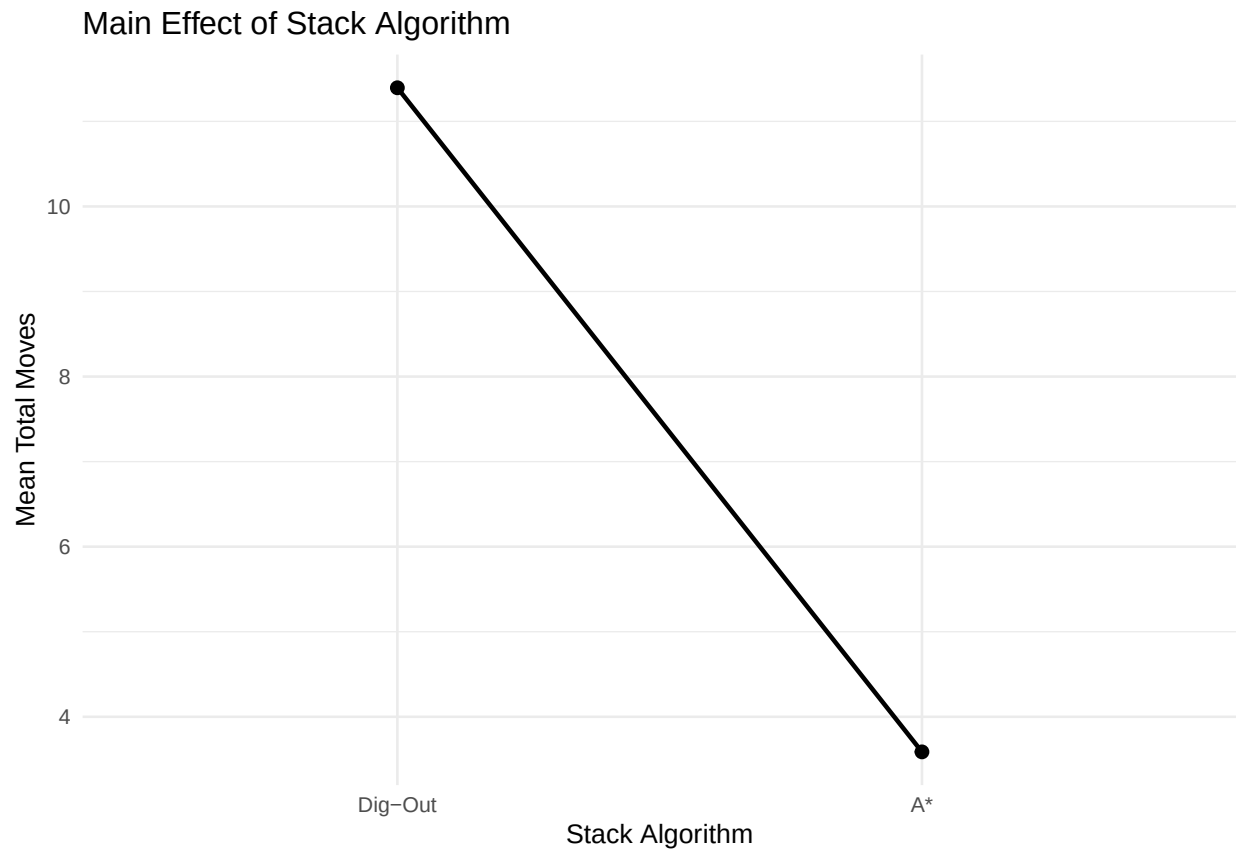
# Main effect: Stack Algorithm

```

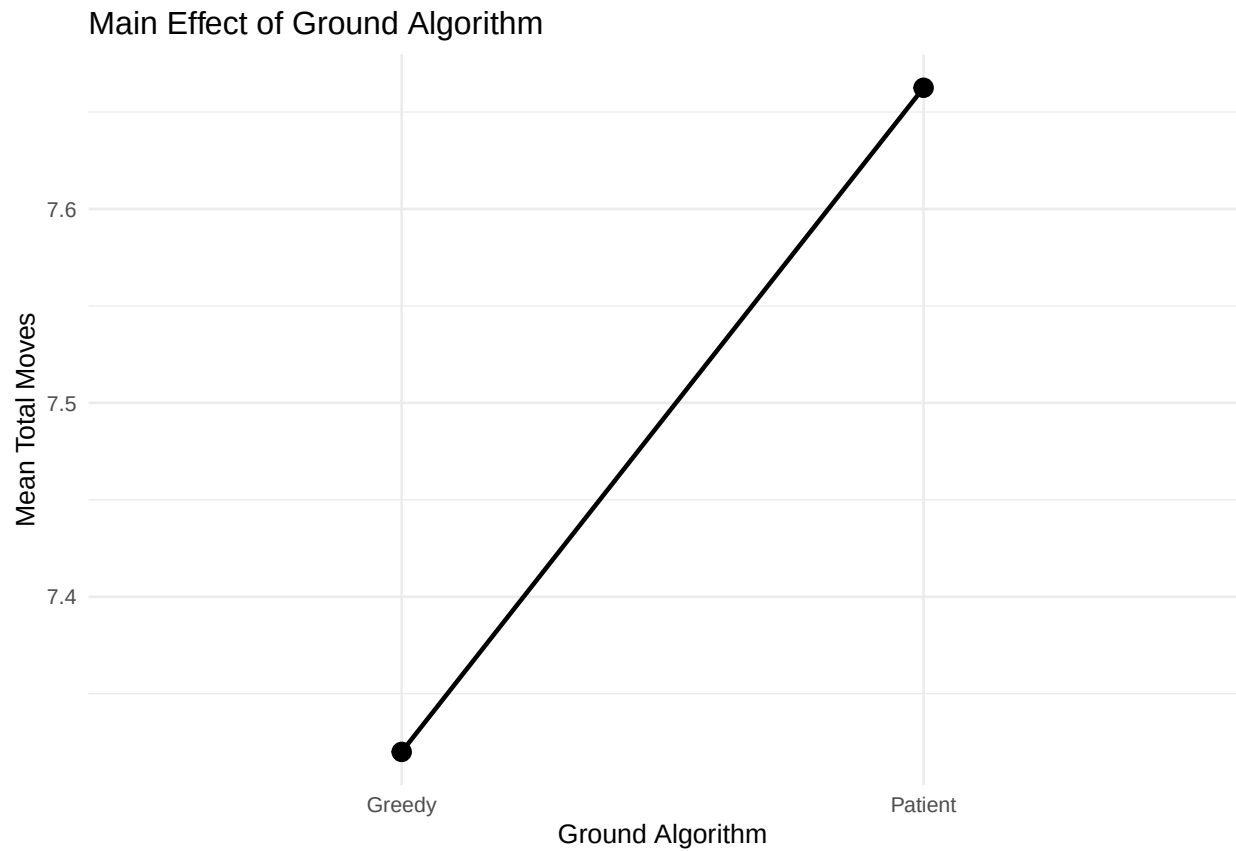
```

ggplot(data, aes(x = stack, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 2) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), linewidth = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Stack Algorithm",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Stack Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)

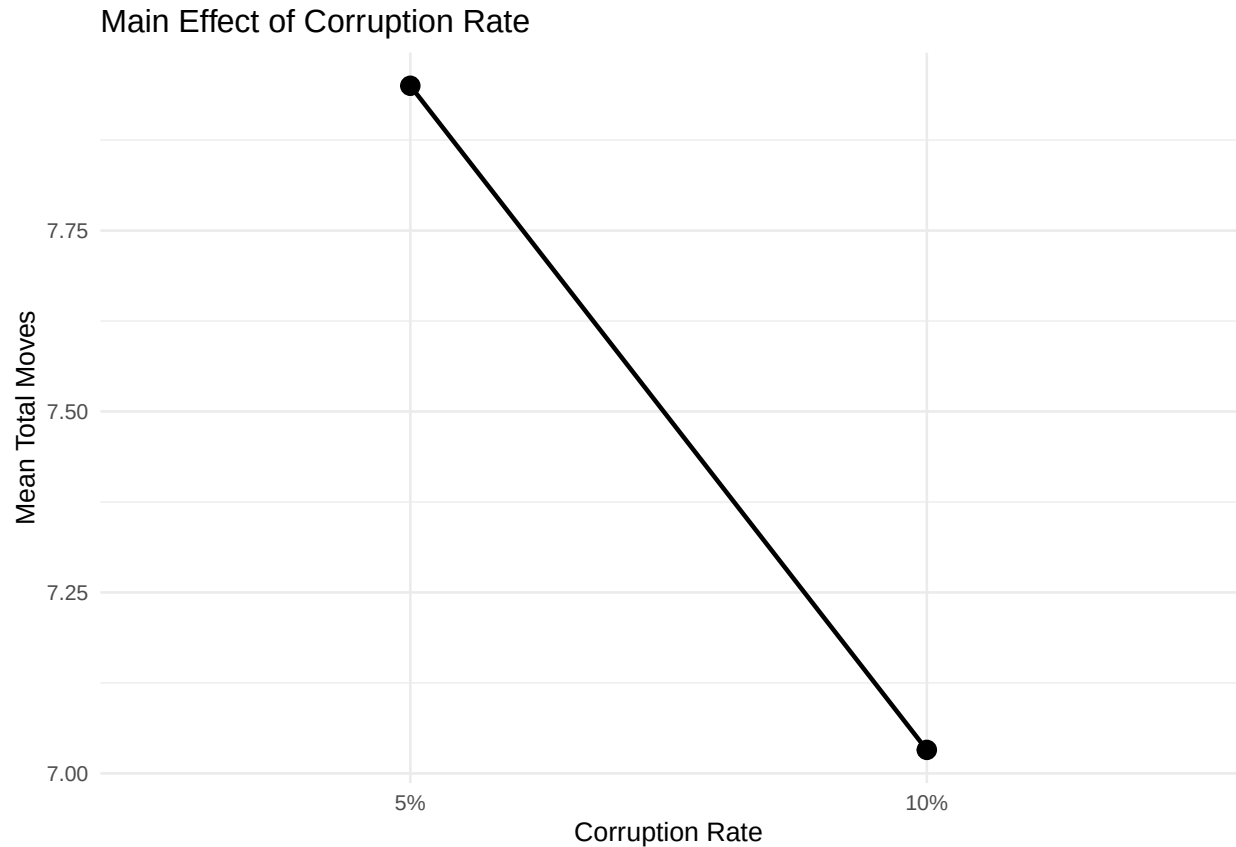
```



```
# Main effect: Ground Algorithm
ggplot(data, aes(x = ground, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 3) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), linewidth = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Ground Algorithm",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Ground Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
```



```
# Main effect: Corruption Rate
ggplot(data, aes(x = corruption, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 3) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), linewidth = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Corruption Rate",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Corruption Rate") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
```



```
# Calculate group means for interaction plots
```

```
group_means <- data %>%
  group_by(stack, ground, corruption) %>%
  summarise(
    mean_value = mean(value),
    sd = sd(value),
    n = n(),
    se = sd / sqrt(n),
    .groups = 'drop'
  )
```

```
print(group_means)
```

```
## # A tibble: 8 x 7
```

```
##   stack   ground corruption mean_value    sd     n    se
##   <fct>   <fct>   <fct>      <dbl> <dbl> <int> <dbl>
## 1 Dig-Out Greedy  5%         11.3    7.70   100 0.770
## 2 Dig-Out Greedy 10%         10.9    7.33   100 0.733
## 3 Dig-Out Patient 5%         13.6   11.0    100 1.10
## 4 Dig-Out Patient 10%         9.74    6.83   100 0.683
## 5 A*      Greedy  5%         3.46    2.50   100 0.250
## 6 A*      Greedy 10%         3.6     2.53   100 0.253
## 7 A*      Patient 5%         3.39    2.38   100 0.238
## 8 A*      Patient 10%         3.9     2.44   100 0.244
```

```

# Two-way interaction plots
# 1. Stack × Corruption
group_means_sc <- data %>%
  group_by(stack, corruption) %>%
  summarise(
    mean_value = mean(value),
    sd = sd(value),
    n = n(),
    se = sd / sqrt(n),
    .groups = 'drop'
  )

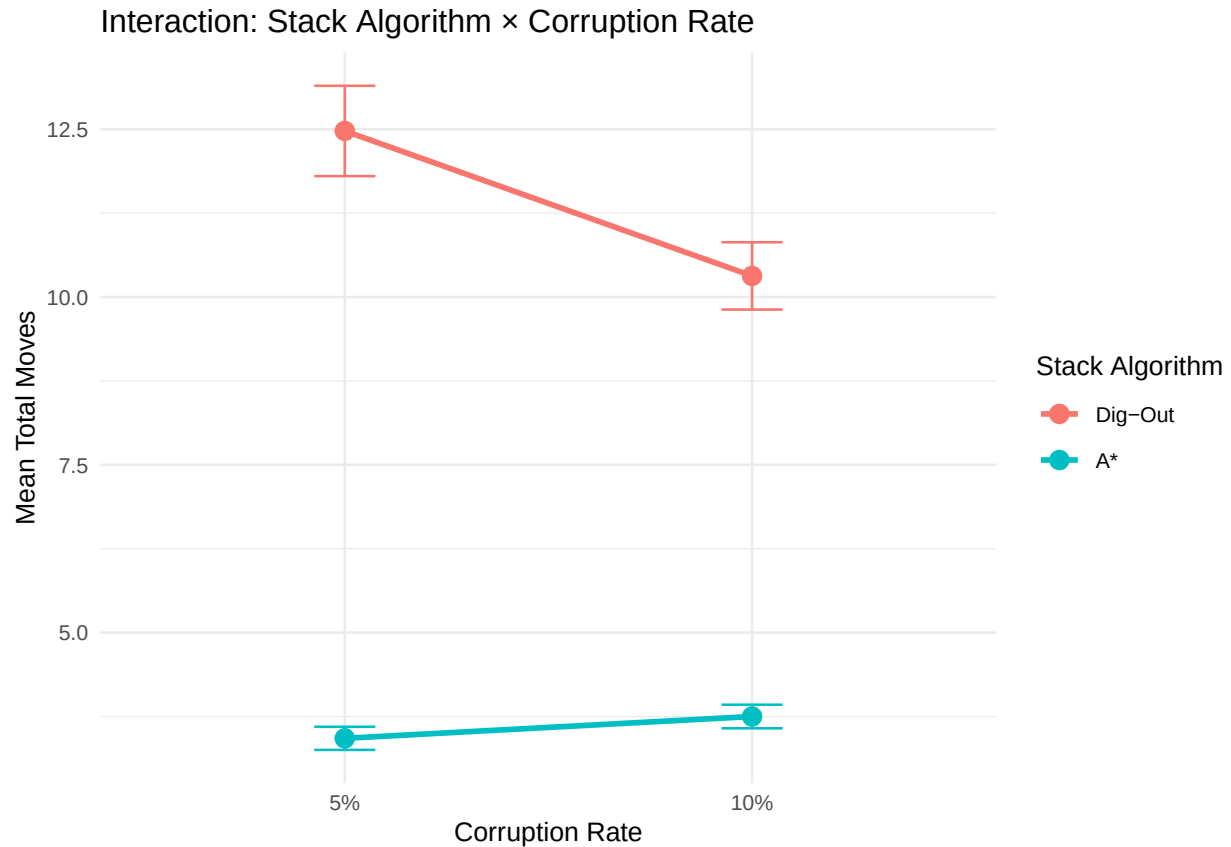
ggplot(group_means_sc, aes(x = corruption, y = mean_value, color = stack, group = stack)) +
  geom_line(size = 1) +
  geom_point(size = 3) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = mean_value - se, ymax = mean_value + se), width = 0.15) +
  labs(title = "Interaction: Stack Algorithm × Corruption Rate",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Corruption Rate",
       color = "Stack Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)

```

```

## Warning: Using 'size' aesthetic for lines was deprecated in ggplot2 3.4.0.
## i Please use 'linewidth' instead.
## This warning is displayed once every 8 hours.
## Call 'lifecycle::last_lifecycle_warnings()' to see where this warning was
## generated.

```



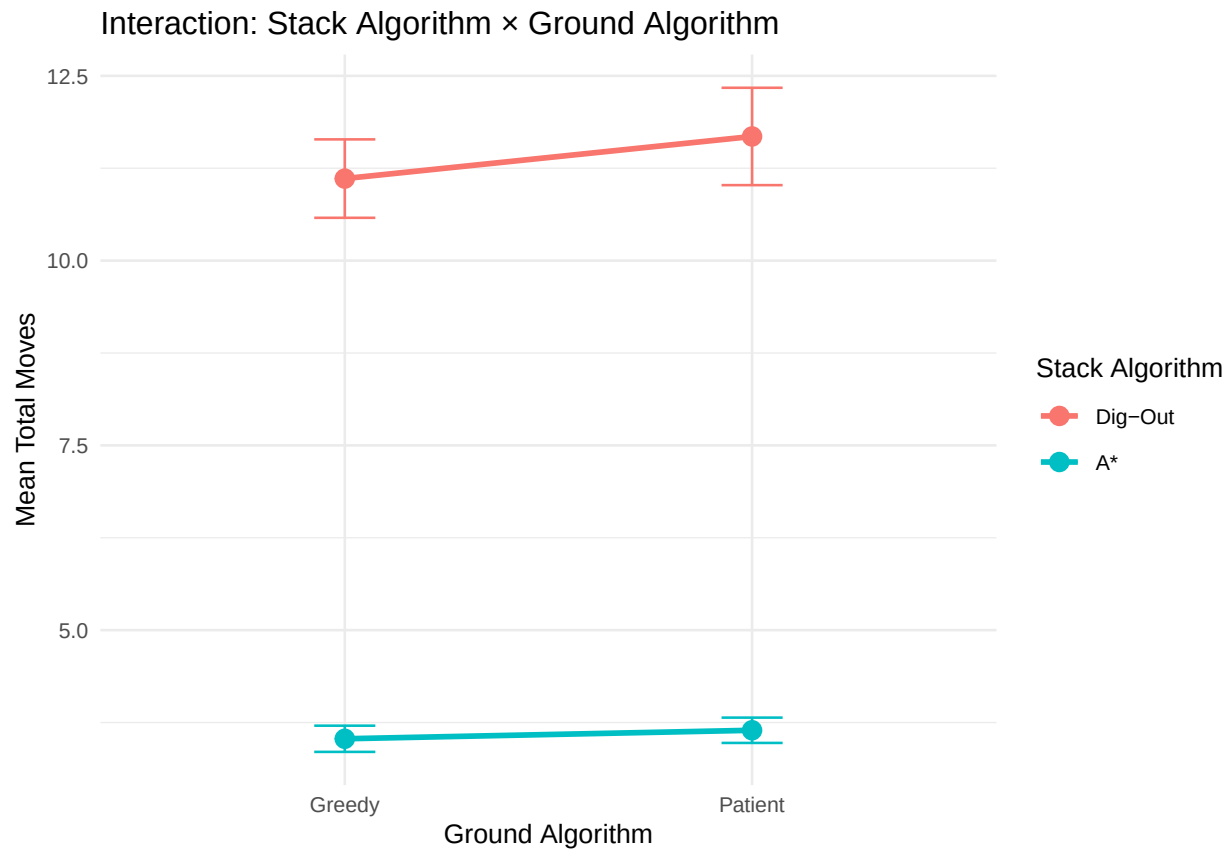
```
# 2. Ground × Corruption
group_means_gc <- data %>%
  group_by(ground, corruption) %>%
  summarise(
    mean_value = mean(value),
    sd = sd(value),
    n = n(),
    se = sd / sqrt(n),
    .groups = 'drop'
  )

ggplot(group_means_gc, aes(x = corruption, y = mean_value, color = ground, group = ground)) +
  geom_line(size = 1) +
  geom_point(size = 3) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = mean_value - se, ymax = mean_value + se), width = 0.15) +
  labs(title = "Interaction: Ground Algorithm × Corruption Rate",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Corruption Rate",
       color = "Ground Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
```

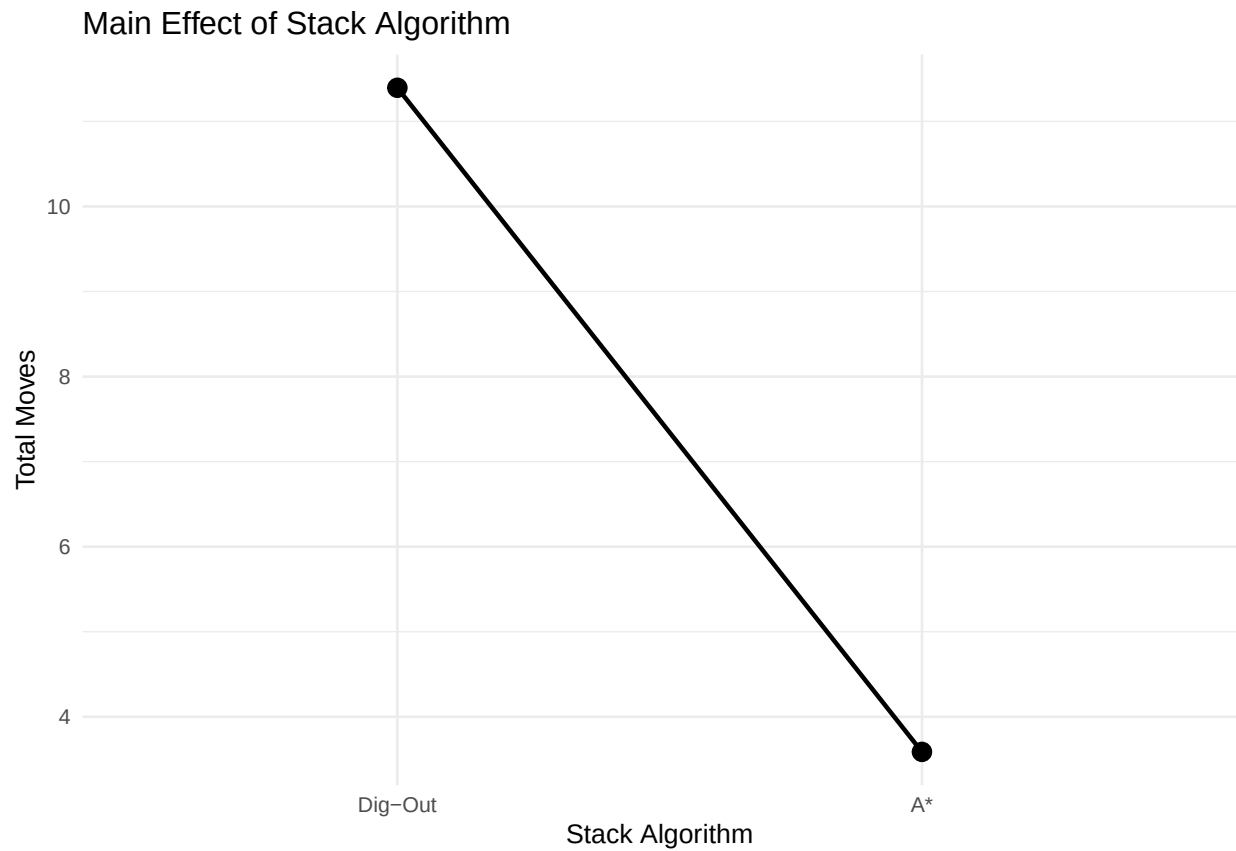


```
# 3. Stack × Ground
group_means_sg <- data %>%
  group_by(stack, ground) %>%
  summarise(
    mean_value = mean(value),
    sd = sd(value),
    n = n(),
    se = sd / sqrt(n),
    .groups = 'drop'
  )

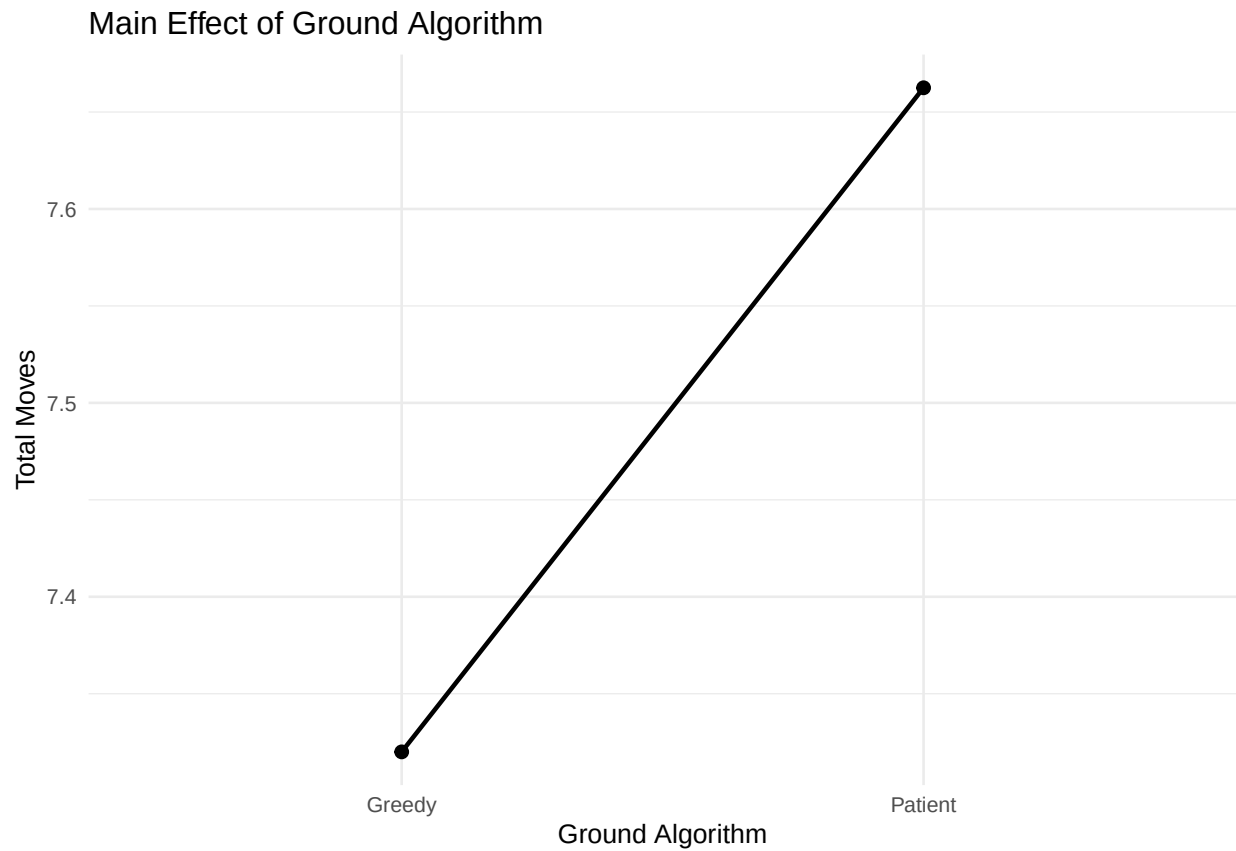
ggplot(group_means_sg, aes(x = ground, y = mean_value, color = stack, group = stack)) +
  geom_line(size = 1) +
  geom_point(size = 3) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = mean_value - se, ymax = mean_value + se), width = 0.15) +
  labs(title = "Interaction: Stack Algorithm × Ground Algorithm",
       y = "Mean Total Moves",
       x = "Ground Algorithm",
       color = "Stack Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
```

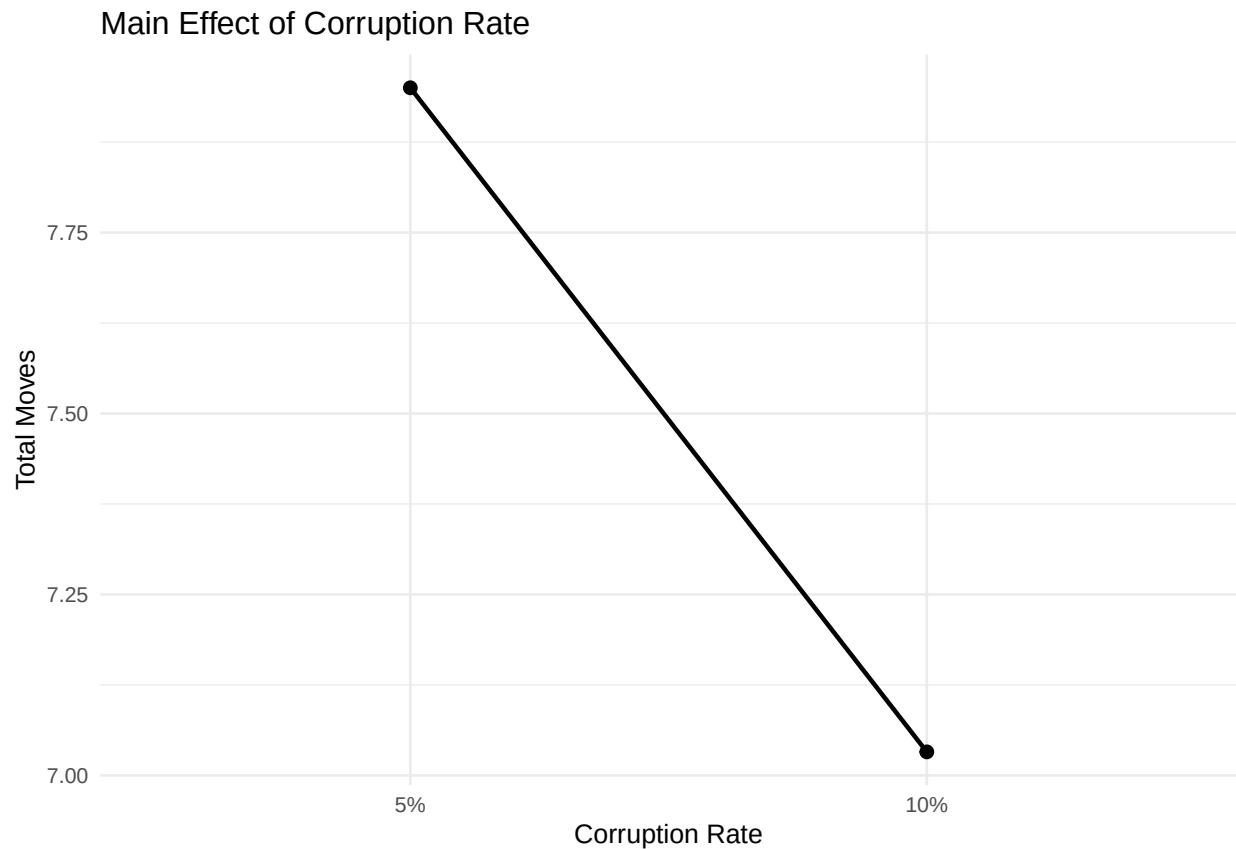
```
# Create visualization of main effects
# 1. Stack Algorithm effect
p1 <- ggplot(data, aes(x = stack, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 3) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), size = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Stack Algorithm",
        y = "Total Moves",
        x = "Stack Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
print(p1)
```



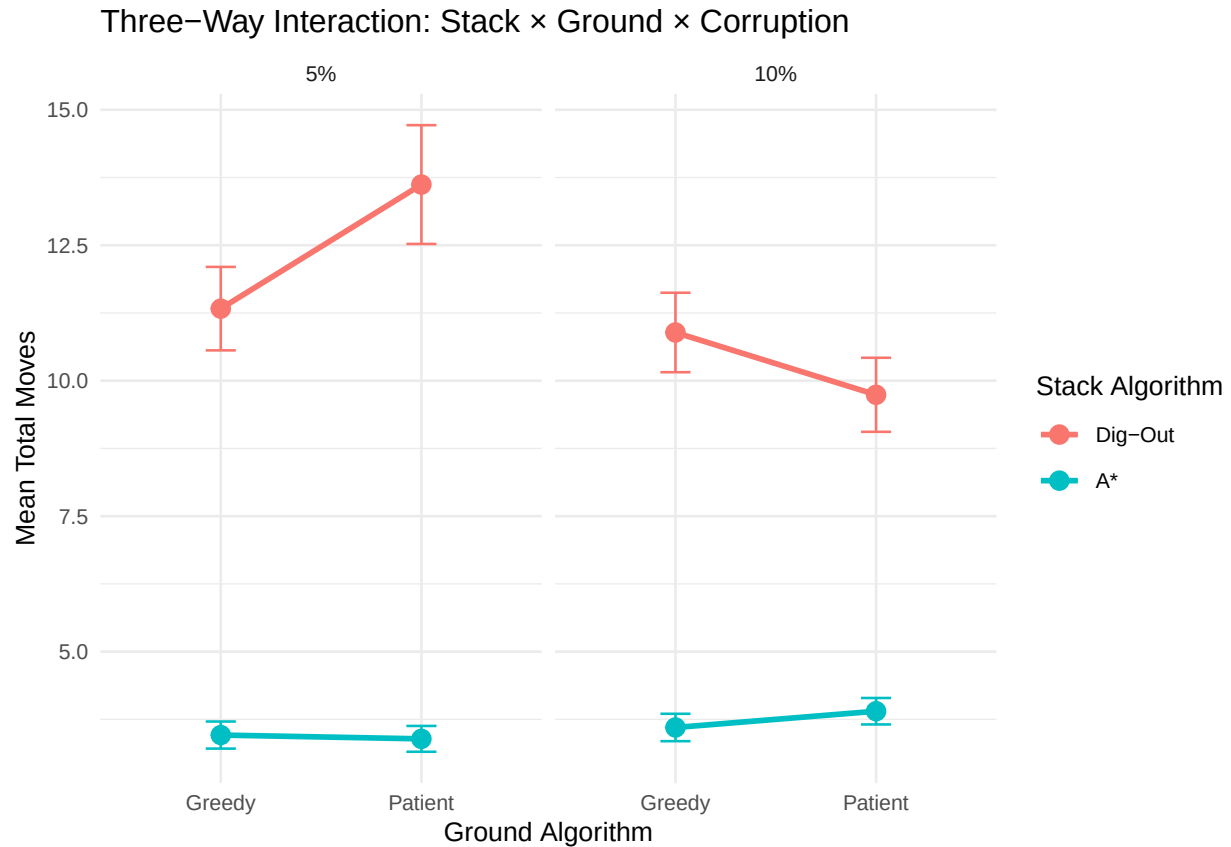
```
# 2. Ground Algorithm effect
p2 <- ggplot(data, aes(x = ground, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 2) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), size = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Ground Algorithm",
       y = "Total Moves",
       x = "Ground Algorithm") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
print(p2)
```



```
# 3. Corruption Rate effect
p3 <- ggplot(data, aes(x = corruption, y = value)) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "point", size = 2) +
  stat_summary(fun = mean, geom = "line", aes(group = 1), size = 0.8) +
  labs(title = "Main Effect of Corruption Rate",
        y = "Total Moves",
        x = "Corruption Rate") +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
print(p3)
```



```
# 4. Three-way interaction plot (Stack × Ground faceted by Corruption)
p4 <- ggplot(group_means, aes(x = ground, y = mean_value, color = stack, group = stack)) +
  geom_line(size = 1) +
  geom_point(size = 3) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = mean_value - se, ymax = mean_value + se), width = 0.15) +
  facet_wrap(~corruption) +
  labs(
    title = "Three-Way Interaction: Stack × Ground × Corruption",
    x = "Ground Algorithm",
    y = "Mean Total Moves",
    color = "Stack Algorithm"
  ) +
  theme_minimal(base_size = 10)
print(p4)
```

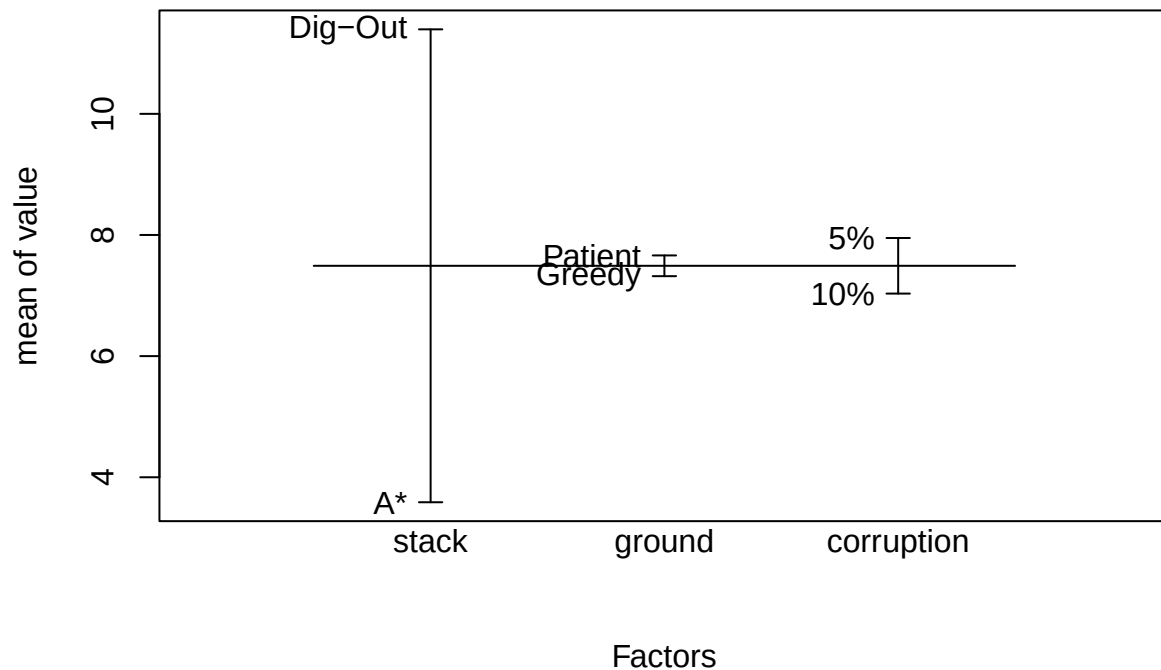


```
# Fit three-way ANOVA model with all interactions
# Model: Total Moves ~ Stack * Ground * Corruption
model <- aov(value ~ stack * ground * corruption, data = data)

# Display ANOVA table with significance tests
summary(model)
```

```
##              Df Sum Sq Mean Sq F value    Pr(>F)
## stack          1 12191    12191 320.610 < 2e-16 ***
## ground          1    23         23   0.617  0.43240
## corruption      1   168        168   4.428  0.03568 *
## stack:ground    1    10         10   0.272  0.60199
## stack:corruption 1   309        309   8.120  0.00449 **
## ground:corruption 1   118        118   3.098  0.07876 .
## stack:ground:corruption 1   181        181   4.772  0.02922 *
## Residuals      792 30116         38
## ---
## Signif. codes:  0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1
```

```
# Store results and create effects plot
anova_sum <- summary(model)[[1]]
plot.design(value ~ stack + ground + corruption, data = data)
```



```
# Sample Size Calculation
k <- 8 # Number of groups (2 stack × 2 ground × 2 corruption)
f <- 0.25 # Small-medium effect size for algorithm comparisons
pwr_result <- pwr.anova.test(k = k, f = f, sig.level = 0.05, power = 0.9)
cat("Required sample size per group:", ceiling(pwr_result$n), "\n")
```

```
## Required sample size per group: 38
```

```
# Calculate statistical power from the experiment
# Define parameters
k <- 8 # total number of groups (2 × 2 × 2)
n_per_group <- nrow(data) / k # samples per group
f <- 0.25 # small-medium effect size for algorithm performance
# Calculate power
sample_calc <- pwr.anova.test(k = k, n = n_per_group, f = f, sig.level = 0.05)$power
# Print results
cat("Actual power achieved:", round(sample_calc, 4), "\n")
```

```
## Actual power achieved: 0.9999
```

```
# Tukey's HSD Test
tukey_result <- TukeyHSD(model)
print(tukey_result)
```

```

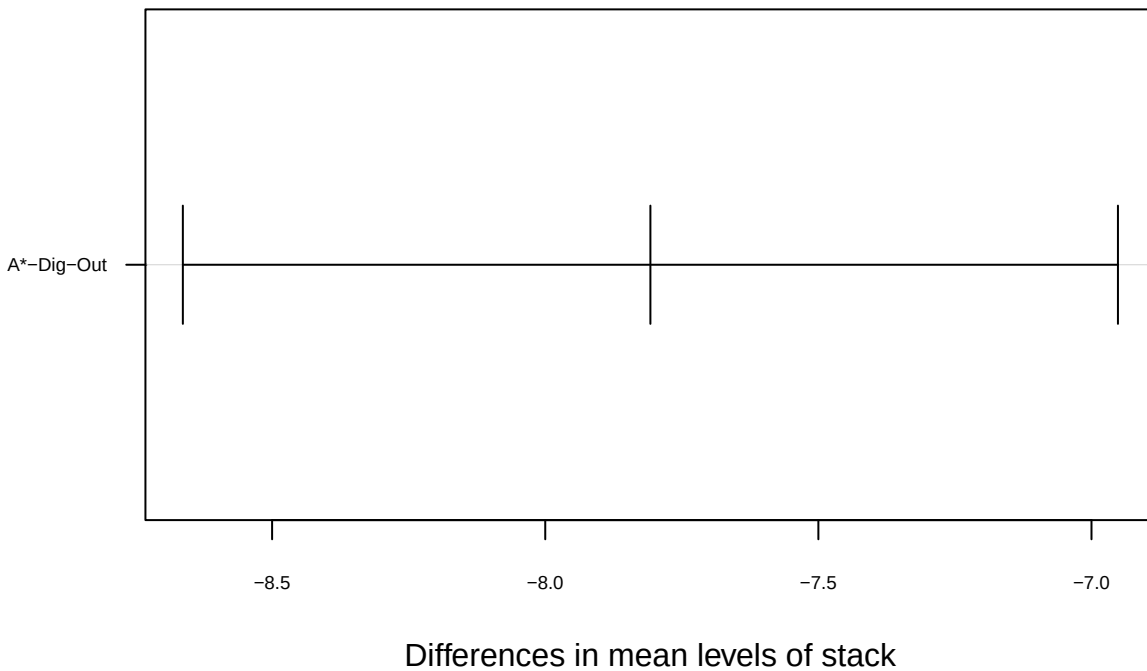
## Tukey multiple comparisons of means
## 95% family-wise confidence level
##
## Fit: aov(formula = value ~ stack * ground * corruption, data = data)
##
## $stack
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## A*-Dig-Out -7.8075 -8.663425 -6.951575 0
##
## $ground
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## Patient-Greedy 0.3425 -0.513425 1.198425 0.432405
##
## $corruption
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## 10%-5% -0.9175 -1.773425 -0.06157501 0.0356775
##
## $'stack:ground'
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## A*:Greedy-Dig-Out:Greedy -7.580 -9.16756 -5.99244 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient-Dig-Out:Greedy 0.570 -1.01756 2.15756 0.7918235
## A*:Patient-Dig-Out:Greedy -7.465 -9.05256 -5.87744 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient-A*:Greedy 8.150 6.56244 9.73756 0.0000000
## A*:Patient-A*:Greedy 0.115 -1.47256 1.70256 0.9976985
## A*:Patient-Dig-Out:Patient -8.035 -9.62256 -6.44744 0.0000000
##
## $'stack:corruption'
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## A*:5%-Dig-Out:5% -9.050 -10.63756 -7.4624396 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:10%-Dig-Out:5% -2.160 -3.74756 -0.5724396 0.0027327
## A*:10%-Dig-Out:5% -8.725 -10.31256 -7.1374396 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:10%-A*:5% 6.890 5.30244 8.4775604 0.0000000
## A*:10%-A*:5% 0.325 -1.26256 1.9125604 0.9525367
## A*:10%-Dig-Out:10% -6.565 -8.15256 -4.9774396 0.0000000
##
## $'ground:corruption'
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## Patient:5%-Greedy:5% 1.110 -0.4775604 2.69756039 0.2740371
## Greedy:10%-Greedy:5% -0.150 -1.7375604 1.43756039 0.9949391
## Patient:10%-Greedy:5% -0.575 -2.1625604 1.01256039 0.7874198
## Greedy:10%-Patient:5% -1.260 -2.8475604 0.32756039 0.1730897
## Patient:10%-Patient:5% -1.685 -3.2725604 -0.09743961 0.0325144
## Patient:10%-Greedy:10% -0.425 -2.0125604 1.16256039 0.9012298
##
## $'stack:ground:corruption'
##           diff          lwr          upr p adj
## A*:Greedy:5%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -7.87 -10.5202641 -5.21973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:5%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% 2.29 -0.3602641 4.94026412 0.1481288
## A*:Patient:5%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -7.94 -10.5902641 -5.28973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Greedy:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -0.44 -3.0902641 2.21026412 0.9996403
## A*:Greedy:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -7.73 -10.3802641 -5.07973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -1.59 -4.2402641 1.06026412 0.6043445
## A*:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:5% -7.43 -10.0802641 -4.77973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:5%-A*:Greedy:5% 10.16 7.5097359 12.81026412 0.0000000

```

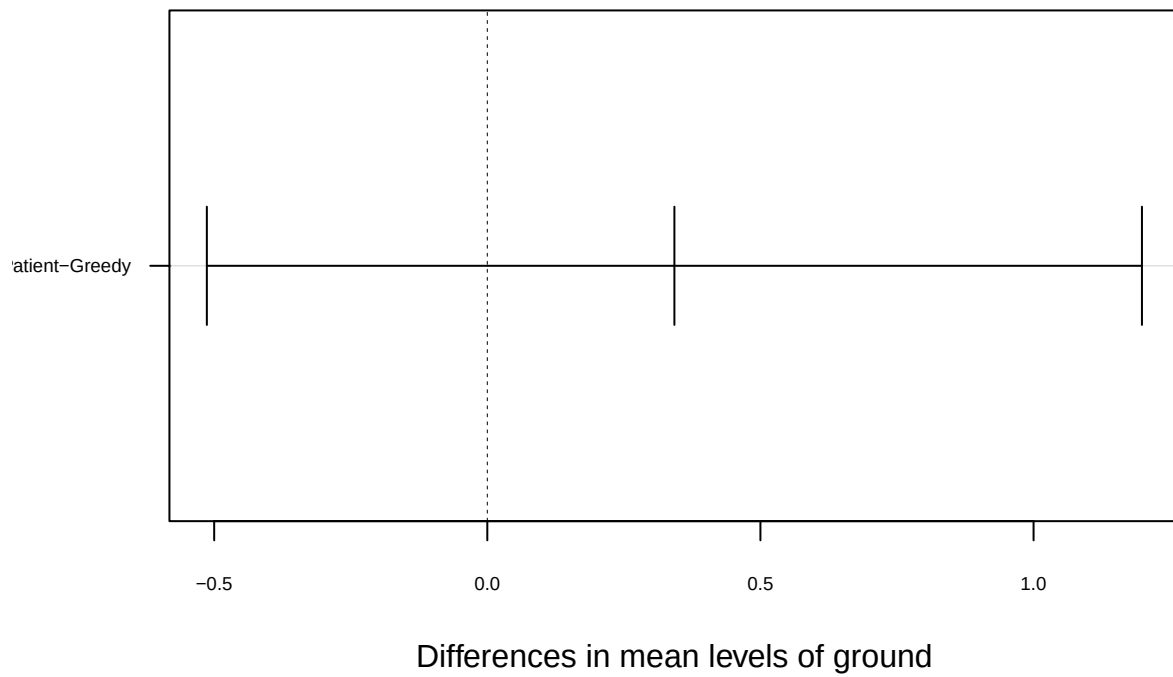
```
## A*:Patient:5%-A*:Greedy:5%          -0.07  -2.7202641  2.58026412 1.0000000
## Dig-Out:Greedy:10%-A*:Greedy:5%      7.43   4.7797359 10.08026412 0.0000000
## A*:Greedy:10%-A*:Greedy:5%           0.14  -2.5102641  2.79026412 0.9999999
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-A*:Greedy:5%      6.28   3.6297359  8.93026412 0.0000000
## A*:Patient:10%-A*:Greedy:5%          0.44  -2.2102641  3.09026412 0.9996403
## A*:Patient:5%-Dig-Out:Patient:5%     -10.23 -12.8802641 -7.57973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Greedy:10%-Dig-Out:Patient:5% -2.73  -5.3802641 -0.07973588 0.0381435
## A*:Greedy:10%-Dig-Out:Patient:5%     -10.02 -12.6702641 -7.36973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Patient:5% -3.88  -6.5302641 -1.22973588 0.0002633
## A*:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Patient:5%     -9.72 -12.3702641 -7.06973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Greedy:10%-A*:Patient:5%      7.50   4.8497359 10.15026412 0.0000000
## A*:Greedy:10%-A*:Patient:5%           0.21  -2.4402641  2.86026412 0.9999977
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-A*:Patient:5%      6.35   3.6997359  9.00026412 0.0000000
## A*:Patient:10%-A*:Patient:5%          0.51  -2.1402641  3.16026412 0.9990506
## A*:Greedy:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:10%     -7.29  -9.9402641 -4.63973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:10% -1.15  -3.8002641  1.50026412 0.8917779
## A*:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Greedy:10%     -6.99  -9.6402641 -4.33973588 0.0000000
## Dig-Out:Patient:10%-A*:Greedy:10%      6.14   3.4897359  8.79026412 0.0000000
## A*:Patient:10%-A*:Greedy:10%          0.30  -2.3502641  2.95026412 0.9999728
## A*:Patient:10%-Dig-Out:Patient:10%    -5.84  -8.4902641 -3.18973588 0.0000000
```

```
plot(tukey_result, las = 1, cex.axis = 0.6)
```

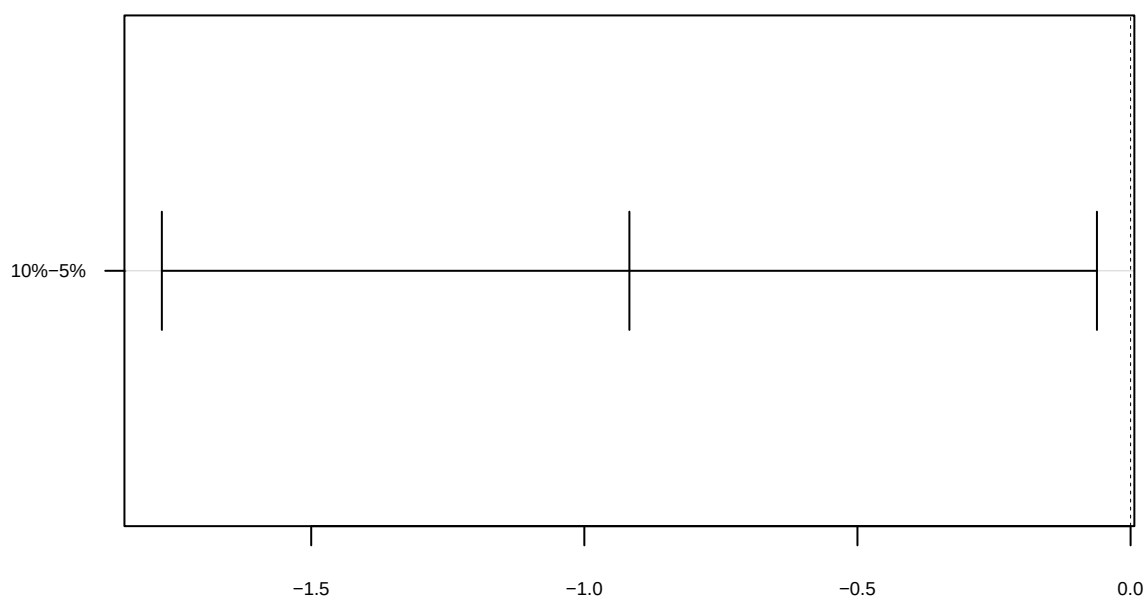
95% family-wise confidence level



95% family-wise confidence level

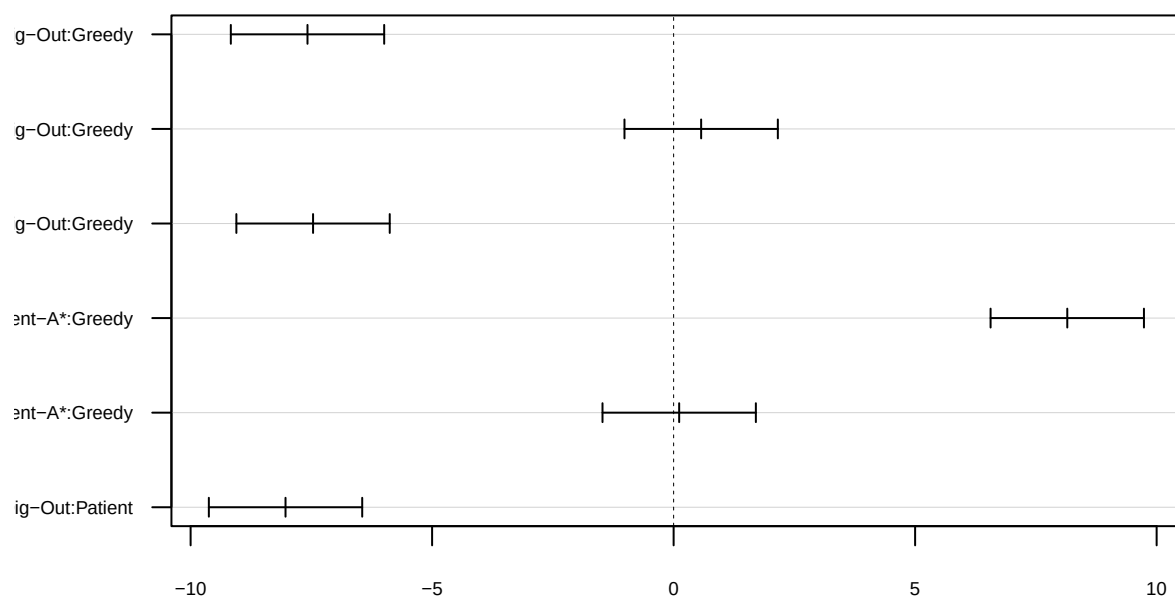


95% family-wise confidence level



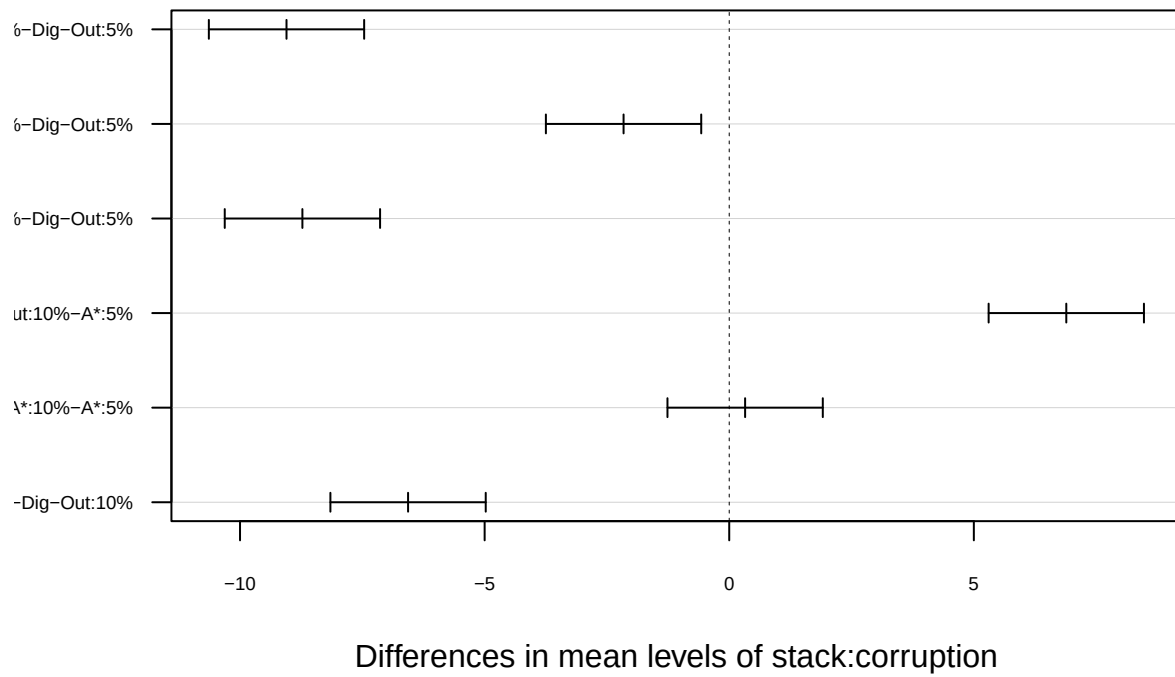
Differences in mean levels of corruption

95% family-wise confidence level

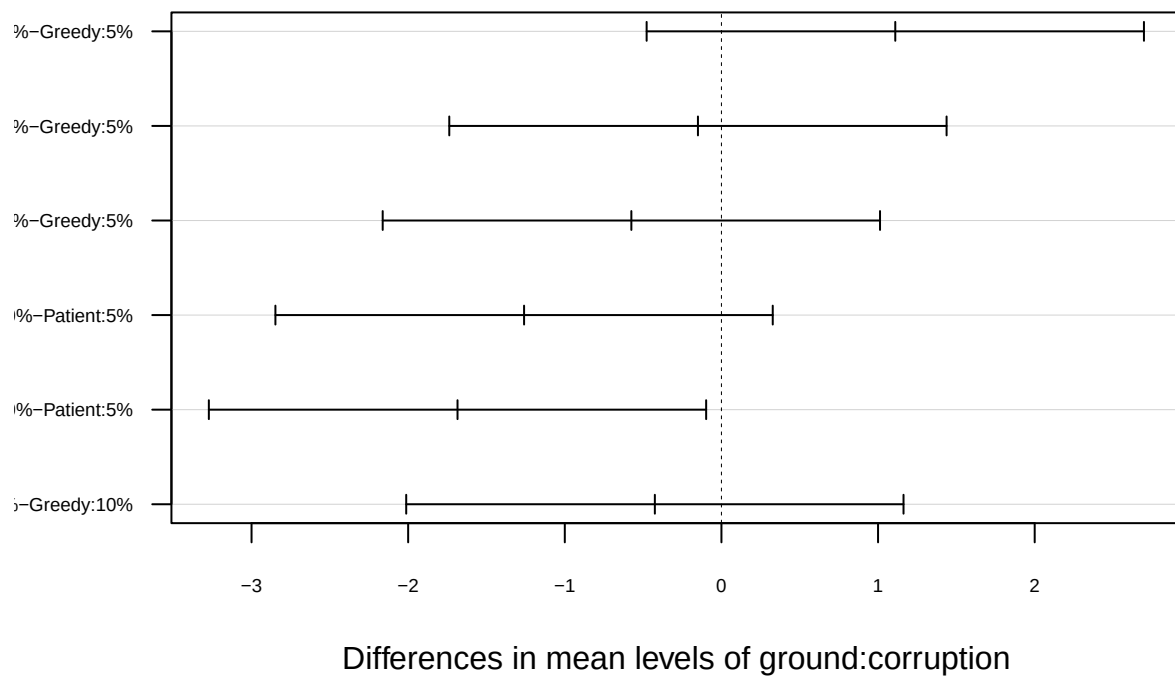


Differences in mean levels of stack:ground

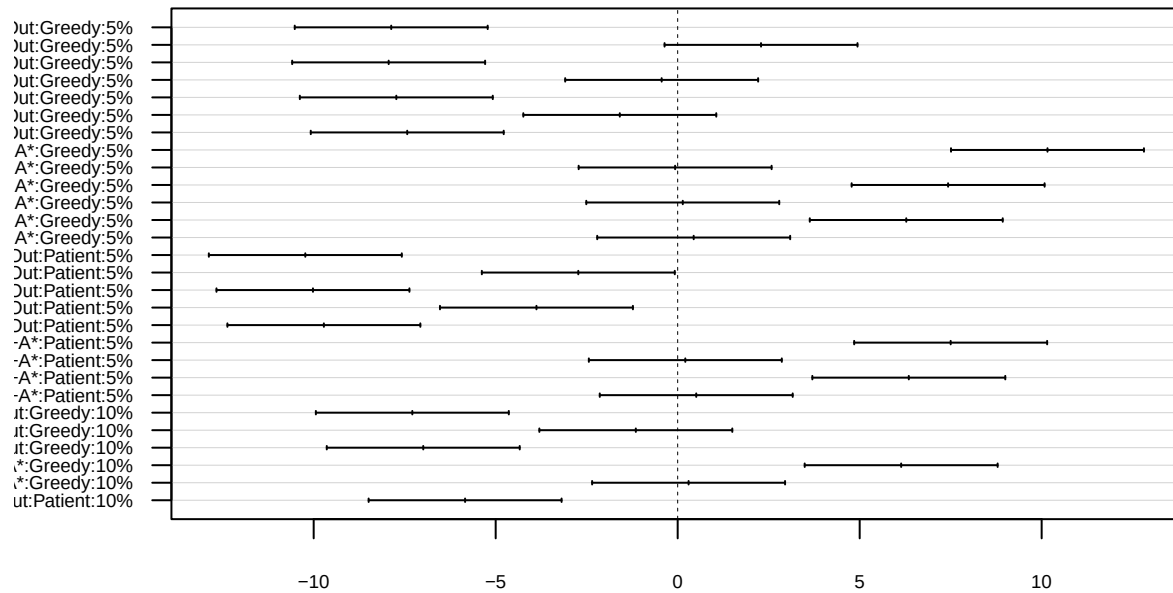
95% family-wise confidence level



95% family-wise confidence level



95% family-wise confidence level



Differences in mean levels of stack:ground:corruption

```
# Fisher's LSD Test
lsd_resultStack <- LSD.test(model, "stack", p.adj = "none")
lsd_resultGround <- LSD.test(model, "ground", p.adj = "none")
lsd_resultCorr <- LSD.test(model, "corruption", p.adj = "none")
print(lsd_resultStack)
```

```
## $statistics
##      MSerror  Df      Mean      CV  t.value      LSD
##      38.02567 792  7.49125 82.31598 1.962964 0.855925
##
## $parameters
##      test p.adjusted name.t ntr alpha
##      Fisher-LSD      none  stack   2  0.05
##
## $means
##      value      std    r      se      LCL      UCL Min Max Q25 Q50   Q75
## A*      3.5875 2.462214 400 0.3083248 2.98227 4.19273 1 18 2 3 4.00
## Dig-Out 11.3950 8.452668 400 0.3083248 10.78977 12.00023 1 69 5 9 14.25
##
## $comparison
## NULL
##
## $groups
##      value groups
## Dig-Out 11.3950 a
```

```
## A*      3.5875      b
##
## attr(,"class")
## [1] "group"
```

```
print(lsd_resultGround)
```

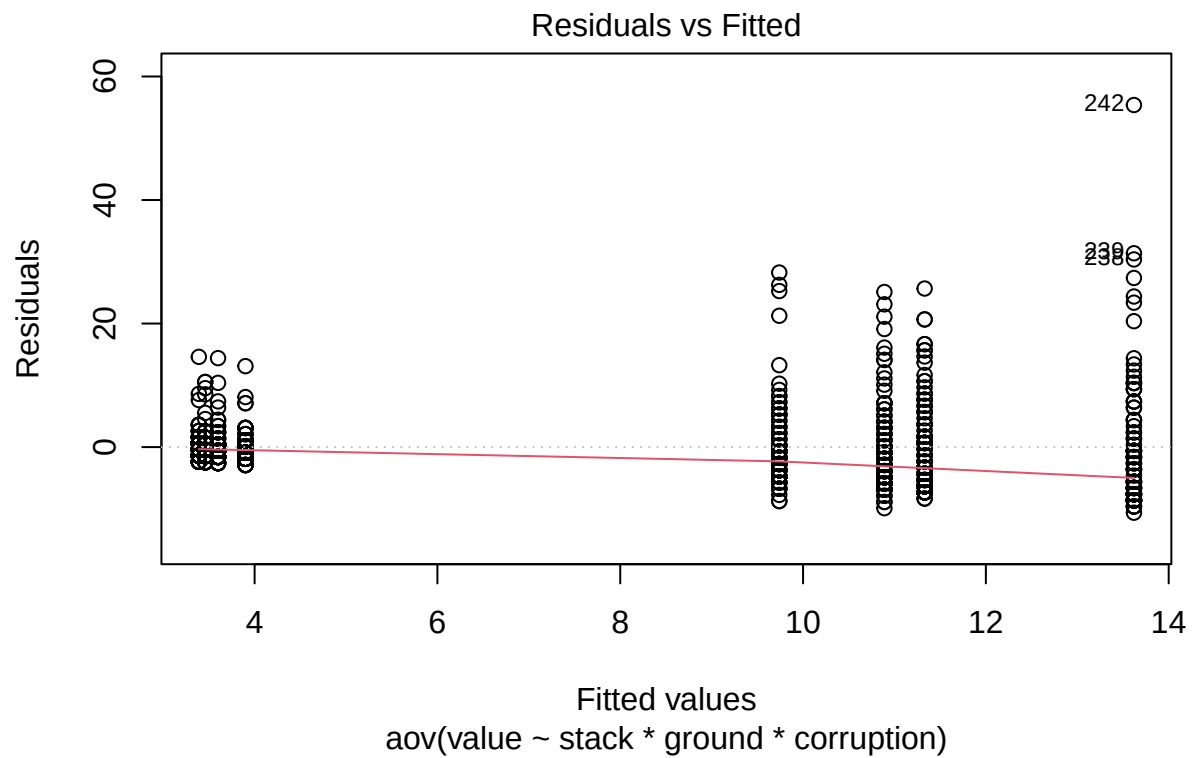
```
## $statistics
##      MSerror Df      Mean      CV  t.value      LSD
##  38.02567 792 7.49125 82.31598 1.962964 0.855925
##
## $parameters
##      test p.adjusted name.t ntr alpha
##  Fisher-LSD      none ground  2  0.05
##
## $means
##      value      std  r      se      LCL      UCL Min Max Q25 Q50 Q75
## Greedy  7.3200 6.754751 400 0.3083248 6.71477 7.92523  1  37  3  5 10
## Patient 7.6625 7.898072 400 0.3083248 7.05727 8.26773  1  69  3  5  9
##
## $comparison
## NULL
##
## $groups
##      value groups
## Patient 7.6625      a
## Greedy  7.3200      a
##
## attr(,"class")
## [1] "group"
```

```
print(lsd_resultCorr)
```

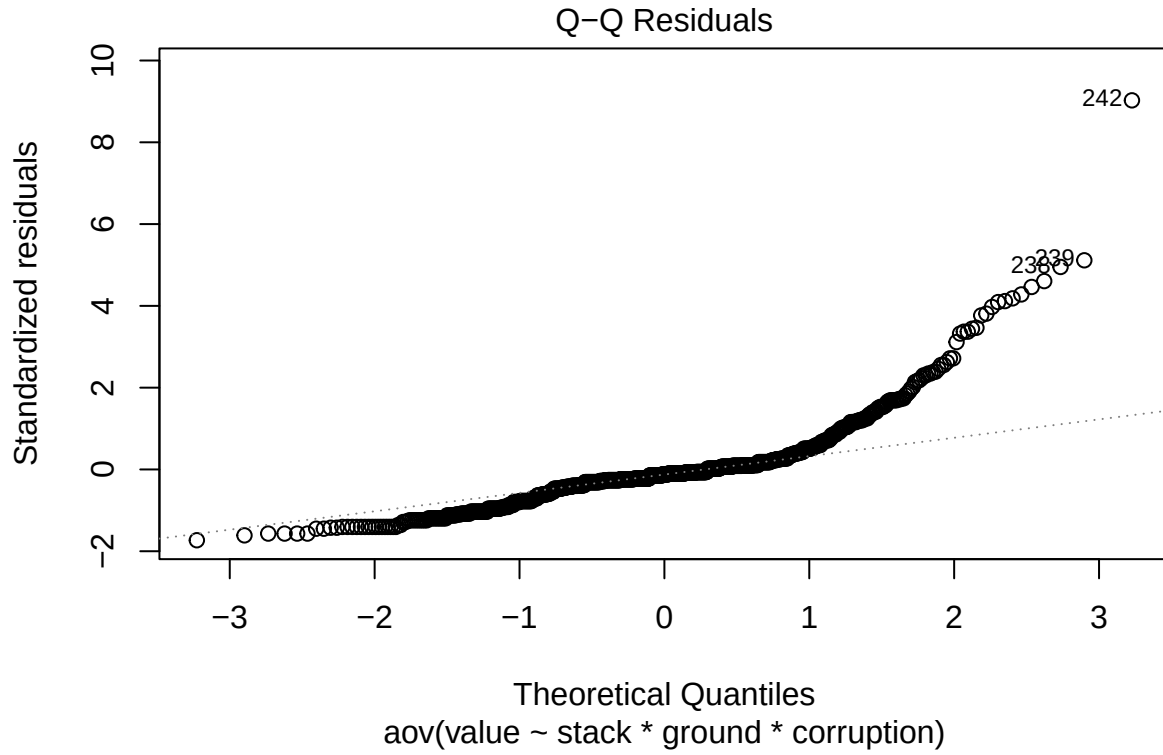
```
## $statistics
##      MSerror Df      Mean      CV  t.value      LSD
##  38.02567 792 7.49125 82.31598 1.962964 0.855925
##
## $parameters
##      test p.adjusted      name.t ntr alpha
##  Fisher-LSD      none corruption  2  0.05
##
## $means
##      value      std  r      se      LCL      UCL Min Max Q25 Q50  Q75
## 10% 7.0325 6.242505 400 0.3083248 6.42727 7.63773  1  38  3  5  9.00
## 5%  7.9500 8.286989 400 0.3083248 7.34477 8.55523  1  69  3  5 10.25
##
## $comparison
## NULL
##
## $groups
##      value groups
## 5%  7.9500      a
## 10% 7.0325      b
```

```
##
## attr("class")
## [1] "group"

# Assumption Tests
## Residuals vs Fitted
plot(model, which=1)
```



```
## Q-Q Residuals
plot(model, which=2)
```

Conclusion

Validation

The experiment was statistically robust. The sample size per group was sufficient, and power analysis results confirm the reliability of the findings.

Analysis and Recommendation

The three-way ANOVA examined the effects of **Stack Algorithm**, **Ground Algorithm**, and **Corruption Rate** on the total number of moves required to solve the Tower of Hanoi puzzle with illegal states.

Key findings: * Evaluate which main effects and interactions are statistically significant from the ANOVA table * Identify which algorithm combinations minimize total moves * Assess how corruption rate impacts performance across different algorithm pairs * Use Tukey's HSD results to determine which specific combinations differ significantly

Recommendation: Based on the analysis results, select the algorithm combination that minimizes total moves while maintaining robustness across corruption rates.